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1 Many have undertaken to compose an account of the things that have
been fulfilled among us, [2] just as they were handed down to us by the initial
eyewitnesses and servants of the word. [3] Therefore, having carefully investigated
everything from the beginning, it seemed good also to me to write an orderly
account for you, most excellent Theophilus, [4] so that you may know the certainty
of the things you have been taught.

[5] In the time of Herod king of Judea there was a priest named Zechariah, who
belonged to the priestly division of Abijah, and whose wife Elizabeth was a
daughter of Aaron. [6] Both of them were righteous in the sight of God, walking
blamelessly in all the commandments and decrees of the Lord. [7] But they had no
children, because Elizabeth was barren, and they were both well along in years.
[8] One day while Zechariah's division was on duty and he was serving as priest
before God, [9] he was chosen by lot, according to the custom of the priesthood, to
enter the temple of the Lord and burn incense. [10] And at the hour of the incense
offering, the whole congregation was praying outside. [11] Just then an angel of the
Lord appeared to Zechariah, standing at the right side of the altar of incense.
[12] When Zechariah saw him, he was startled and gripped with fear. [13] But the angel
said to him, "Do not be afraid, Zechariah, because your prayer has been heard.
Your wife Elizabeth will bear you a son, and you are to give him the name John."
[14] He will be a joy and delight to you, and many will rejoice at his birth, [15] for he
will be great in the sight of the Lord. He shall never take wine or strong drink,
and he will be filled with the Holy Spirit even from his mother's womb. [16] Many
of the sons of Israel he will turn back to the Lord their God. [17] "And he will go on
before the Lord in the spirit and power of Elijah, to turn the hearts of the fathers
to their children and the disobedient to the wisdom of the righteous—to make
ready a people prepared for the Lord." [18] "How can I be sure of this?" Zechariah
asked the angel. "I am an old man, and my wife is well along in years." [19] "I am
Gabriel," replied the angel. "I stand in the presence of God, and I have been sent
to speak to you and to bring you this good news." [20] "And now you will be silent
and unable to speak until the day this comes to pass, because you did not believe
my words, which will be fulfilled at their proper time." [21] Meanwhile, the people
were waiting for Zechariah and wondering why he took so long in the temple.
[22] When he came out and was unable to speak to them, they realized he had seen
a vision in the temple. He kept making signs to them but remained speechless.
[23] And when the days of his service were complete, he returned home. [24] After
these days, his wife Elizabeth became pregnant and for five months remained in
seclusion. She declared, [25] "The Lord has done this for me. In these days He has
shown me favor and taken away my disgrace among the people."

[26] In the sixth month, God sent the angel Gabriel to a town in Galilee
called Nazareth, [27] to a virgin pledged in marriage to a man named Joseph,
who was of the house of David. And the virgin's name was Mary. [28] The angel
appeared to her and said, "Greetings, you who are highly favored! The Lord is
with you." [29] Mary was greatly troubled at his words and wondered what kind
of greeting this might be. [30] So the angel told her, "Do not be afraid, Mary, for
you have found favor with God." [31] Behold, you will conceive and give birth to
a son, and you are to give Him the name Jesus. [32] He will be great and will be
called the Son of the Most High. The Lord God will give Him the throne of His
father David, [33] "and He will reign over the house of Jacob forever. His kingdom
will never end!"

[34] "How can this be," Mary asked the angel, "since I am a virgin?" [35] The angel
replied, "The Holy Spirit will come upon you, and the power of the Most High
will overshadow you. So the Holy One to be born will be called the Son of God."
[36] Look, even Elizabeth your relative has conceived a son in her old age, and she
who was called barren is in her sixth month. [37] "For no word from God will
ever fail." [38] "I am the Lord's servant," Mary answered. "May it happen to me
according to your word." Then the angel left her.

[39] In those days Mary got ready and hurried to a town in the hill country
of Judah, [40] where she entered the home of Zechariah and greeted Elizabeth.
[41] When Elizabeth heard Mary's greeting, the baby leaped in her womb, and
Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit. [42] In a loud voice she exclaimed, "Blessed
are you among women, and blessed is the fruit of your womb!" [43] And why am
I so honored, that the mother of my Lord should come to me? [44] For as soon as
the sound of your greeting reached my ears, the baby in my womb leaped for joy.
[45] "Blessed is she who has believed that the Lord's word to her will be fulfilled."

[46] Then Mary said: "My soul magnifies the Lord," [47] and my spirit rejoices in God
my Savior! [48] For He has looked with favor on the humble state of His servant.
From now on all generations will call me blessed. [49] For the Mighty One has done
great things for me. Holy is His name. [50] His mercy extends to those who fear
Him, from generation to generation. [51] He has performed mighty deeds with His
arm; He has scattered those who are proud in the thoughts of their hearts. [52] He
has brought down rulers from their thrones, but has exalted the humble.

[53] He has filled the hungry with good things, but has sent the rich away empty.
[54] He has helped His servant Israel, remembering to be merciful, [55] "as He
promised to our fathers, to Abraham and his descendants forever." [56] Mary stayed
with Elizabeth for about three months and then returned home.

[57] When the time came for Elizabeth to have her child, she gave birth to a son.
[58] Her neighbors and relatives heard that the Lord had shown her great mercy,
and they rejoiced with her. [59] On the eighth day, when they came to circumcise
the child, they were going to name him after his father Zechariah. [60] But his
mother replied, "No! He shall be called John." [61] They said to her, "There is
no one among your relatives who bears this name." [62] So they made signs to his
father to find out what he wanted to name the child. [63] Zechariah asked for a
tablet and wrote, "His name is John." And they were all amazed. [64] Immediately
Zechariah's mouth was opened and his tongue was released, and he began to
speak, praising God. [65] All their neighbors were filled with awe, and people
throughout the hill country of Judea were talking about these events. [66] And all
who heard this wondered in their hearts and asked, "What then will this child
become?" For the Lord's hand was with him. [67] Then his father Zechariah was
filled with the Holy Spirit and prophesied: [68] "Blessed be the Lord, the God of
Israel, because He has visited and redeemed His people." [69] He has raised up a
horn of salvation for us in the house of His servant David, [70] as He spoke through
His holy prophets, those of ages past, [71] salvation from our enemies and from
the hand of all who hate us, [72] to show mercy to our fathers and to remember
His holy covenant, [73] the oath He swore to our father Abraham, to grant us
[74] deliverance from hostile hands, that we may serve Him without fear, [75] in
holiness and righteousness before Him all the days of our lives. [76] And you, child,
will be called a prophet of the Most High; for you will go on before the Lord
to prepare the way for Him, [77] to give to His people the knowledge of salvation
through the forgiveness of their sins, [78] because of the tender mercy of our God,
by which the Dawn will visit us from on high, [79] "to shine on those who live in
darkness and in the shadow of death, to guide our feet into the path of peace."
[80] And the child grew and became strong in spirit; and he lived in the wilderness
until the time of his public appearance to Israel.

2 Now in those days a decree went out from Caesar Augustus that a census
should be taken of the whole empire. [2] This was the first census to take place while
Quirinius was governor of Syria. [3] And everyone went to his own town to register.
[4] So Joseph also went up from Nazareth in Galilee to Judea, to the city of David
called Bethlehem, since he was from the house and line of David. [5] He went there
to register with Mary, who was pledged to him in marriage and was expecting
a child. [6] While they were there, the time came for her Child to be born. [7] And
she gave birth to her firstborn, a Son. She wrapped Him in swaddling cloths and
laid Him in a manger, because there was no room for them in the inn.

[8] And there were shepherds residing in the fields nearby, keeping watch over their
flocks by night. [9] Just then an angel of the Lord stood before them, and the glory
of the Lord shone around them, and they were terrified. [10] But the angel said to
them, "Do not be afraid! For behold, I bring you good news of great joy that
will be for all the people:" [11] Today in the city of David a Savior has been born
to you. He is Christ the Lord! [12] "And this will be a sign to you: You will find
a baby wrapped in swaddling cloths and lying in a manger." [13] And suddenly
there appeared with the angel a great multitude of the heavenly host, praising
God and saying: [14] "Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace to men on
whom His favor rests!" [15] When the angels had left them and gone into heaven,
the shepherds said to one another, "Let us go to Bethlehem and see this thing
that has happened, which the Lord has made known to us." [16] So they hurried
off and found Mary and Joseph and the Baby, who was lying in the manger.

[17] After they had seen the Child, they spread the message they had received
about Him. [18] And all who heard it were amazed at what the shepherds said
to them. [19] But Mary treasured up all these things and pondered them in
her heart. [20] The shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all they had
heard and seen, which was just as the angel had told them.

[21] When the eight days until His circumcision had passed, He was named Jesus,
the name the angel had given Him before He had been conceived.

[22] And when the time of purification according to the Law of Moses was
complete, His parents brought Him to Jerusalem to present Him to the Lord
[23] (as it is written in the Law of the Lord: "Every firstborn male shall be
consecrated to the Lord"), [24] and to offer the sacrifice specified in the Law of the
Lord: "A pair of turtledoves or two young pigeons." [25] Now there was a man in
Jerusalem named Simeon, who was righteous and devout. He was waiting for the
consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit was upon him. [26] The Holy Spirit had
revealed to him that he would not see death before he had seen the Lord's Christ.
[27] Led by the Spirit, he went into the temple courts. And when the parents
brought in the child Jesus to do for Him what was customary under the Law,
[28] Simeon took Him in his arms and blessed God, saying: [29] "Sovereign Lord, as
You have promised, You now dismiss Your servant in peace." [30] For my eyes have
seen Your salvation, [31] which You have prepared in the sight of all people, [32] "a
light for revelation to the Gentiles, and for glory to Your people Israel." [33] The
Child's father and mother were amazed at what was spoken about Him.

[34] Then Simeon blessed them and said to His mother Mary: "Behold, this Child is
appointed to cause the rise and fall of many in Israel, and to be a sign that will be
spoken against," [35] "so that the thoughts of many hearts will be revealed— and a
sword will pierce your soul as well." [36] There was also a prophetess named Anna,

the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Asher, who was well along in years. She had been married for seven years, [37] and then was a widow to the age of eighty-four. She never left the temple, but worshiped night and day, fasting and praying. [38] Coming forward at that moment, she gave thanks to God and spoke about the Child to all who were waiting for the redemption of Jerusalem. [39] When Jesus' parents had done everything required by the Law of the Lord, they returned to Galilee, to their own town of Nazareth. [40] And the Child grew and became strong. He was filled with wisdom, and the grace of God was upon Him.

[41] Every year His parents went to Jerusalem for the Feast of the Passover. [42] And when He was twelve years old, they went up according to the custom of the Feast. [43] When those days were over and they were returning home, the boy Jesus remained behind in Jerusalem, but His parents were unaware He had stayed. [44] Assuming He was in their company, they traveled on for a day before they began to look for Him among their relatives and friends. [45] When they could not find Him, they returned to Jerusalem to search for Him. [46] Finally, after three days they found Him in the temple courts, sitting among the teachers, listening to them and asking them questions. [47] And all who heard Him were astounded at His understanding and His answers. [48] When His parents saw Him, they were astonished. "Child, why have You done this to us?" His mother asked. "Your father and I have been anxiously searching for You." [49] "Why were you looking for Me?" He asked. "Did you not know that I had to be in My Father's house?" [50] But they did not understand the statement He was making to them. [51] Then He went down to Nazareth with them and was obedient to them. But His mother treasured up all these things in her heart. [52] And Jesus grew in wisdom and stature, and in favor with God and man.

3 In the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar, while Pontius Pilate was governor of Judea, Herod tetrarch of Galilee, his brother Philip tetrarch of Ituraea and Trachonitis, and Lysanias tetrarch of Abilene, [2] during the high priesthood of Annas and Caiaphas, the word of God came to John son of Zechariah in the wilderness. [3] He went into all the region around the Jordan, preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins, [4] as it is written in the book of the words of Isaiah the prophet: "A voice of one calling in the wilderness, 'Prepare the way for the Lord, make straight paths for Him.'" [5] Every valley shall be filled in, and every mountain and hill made low. The crooked ways shall be made straight, and the rough ways smooth. [6] "And all humanity will see God's salvation.'" [7] Then John said to the crowds coming out to be baptized by him, "You brood of vipers, who warned you to flee from the coming wrath?" [8] Produce fruit, then, in keeping with repentance. And do not begin to say to yourselves, 'We have Abraham as our father.' For I tell you that out of these stones God can raise up children for Abraham. [9] "The axe lies ready at the root of the trees, and every tree that does not produce good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire." [10] The crowds asked him, "What then should we do?" [11] John replied, "Whoever has two tunics should share with him who has none, and whoever has food should do the same."

[12] Even tax collectors came to be baptized. "Teacher," they asked, "what should we do?" [13] "Collect no more than you are authorized," he answered. [14] Then some soldiers asked him, "And what should we do?" "Do not take money by force or false accusation," he said. "Be content with your wages." [15] The people were waiting expectantly and were all wondering in their hearts if John could be the Christ. [16] John answered all of them: "I baptize you with water, but One more powerful than I will come, the straps of whose sandals I am not worthy to untie. He will baptize you with the Holy Spirit and with fire." [17] "His winnowing fork is in His hand to clear His threshing floor and to gather the wheat into His barn; but He will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire." [18] With these and many other exhortations, John proclaimed the good news to the people.

[19] But when he rebuked Herod the tetrarch regarding his brother's wife Herodias and all the evils he had done, [20] Herod added this to them all: He locked John up in prison. [21] When all the people were being baptized, Jesus was baptized too. And as He was praying, heaven was opened, [22] and the Holy Spirit descended on Him in a bodily form like a dove. And a voice came from heaven: "You are My beloved Son; in You I am well pleased."

[23] Jesus Himself was about thirty years old when He began His ministry. He was regarded as the son of Joseph, the son of Heli,

[24] the son of Matthat, the son of Levi, the son of Melchi, the son of Jannai, the son of Joseph,

[25] the son of Mattathias, the son of Amos, the son of Nahum, the son of Esli, the son of Naggai,

[26] the son of Maath, the son of Mattathias, the son of Semein, the son of Josech, the son of Joda,

[27] the son of Joanan, the son of Rhesa, the son of Zerubbabel, the son of Shealtiel, the son of Neri,

[28] the son of Melchi, the son of Addi, the son of Cosam, the son of Elmadam, the son of Er,

[29] the son of Joshua, the son of Eliezer, the son of Jorim, the son of Matthat, the son of Levi,

[30] the son of Simeon, the son of Judah, the son of Joseph, the son of Jonam, the son of Eliakim,

[31] the son of Melea, the son of Menna, the son of Mattatha, the son of Nathan, the son of David,

[32] the son of Jesse, the son of Obed, the son of Boaz, the son of Sala, the son of Nahshon,

[33] the son of Amminadab, the son of Admin, the son of Arni, the son of Hezron, the son of Perez, the son of Judah,

[34] the son of Jacob, the son of Isaac, the son of Abraham, the son of Terah, the son of Nahor,

[35] the son of Serug, the son of Reu, the son of Peleg, the son of Eber, the son of Shelah,

[36] the son of Cainan, the son of Arphaxad, the son of Shem, the son of Noah, the son of Lamech,

[37] the son of Methuselah, the son of Enoch, the son of Jared, the son of Mahalalel, the son of Cainan,

[38] the son of Enosh, the son of Seth, the son of Adam, the son of God.

4 Then Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit, returned from the Jordan and was led by the Spirit into the wilderness, [2] where for forty days He was tempted by the devil. He ate nothing during those days, and when they had ended, He was hungry. [3] The devil said to Him, "If You are the Son of God, tell this stone to become bread." [4] But Jesus answered, "It is written: 'Man shall not live on bread alone.'" [5] Then the devil led Him up to a high place and showed Him in an instant all the kingdoms of the world. [6] "I will give You authority over all these kingdoms and all their glory," he said. "For it has been relinquished to me, and I can give it to anyone I wish." [7] "So if You worship me, it will all be Yours." [8] But Jesus answered, "It is written: 'Worship the Lord your God and serve Him only.'" [9] Then the devil led Him to Jerusalem and set Him on the pinnacle of the temple. "If You are the Son of God," he said, "throw Yourself down from here." [10] For it is written: 'He will command His angels concerning You to guard You carefully;' [11] "and they will lift You up in their hands, so that You will not strike Your foot against a stone.'" [12] But Jesus answered, "It also says, 'Do not put the Lord your God to the test.'" [13] When the devil had finished every temptation, he left Him until an opportune time.

[14] Jesus returned to Galilee in the power of the Spirit, and the news about Him spread throughout the surrounding region. [15] He taught in their synagogues and was glorified by everyone. [16] Then Jesus came to Nazareth, where He had been brought up. As was His custom, He entered the synagogue on the Sabbath. And when He stood up to read, [17] the scroll of the prophet Isaiah was handed to Him. Unrolling it, He found the place where it was written: [18] "The Spirit of the Lord is on Me, because He has anointed Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to proclaim liberty to the captives and recovery of sight to the blind, to release the oppressed," [19] "to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor." [20] Then He rolled up the scroll, returned it to the attendant, and sat down. The eyes of everyone in the synagogue were fixed on Him, [21] and He began by saying, "Today this Scripture is fulfilled in your hearing." [22] All spoke well of Him and marveled at the gracious words that came from His lips. "Isn't this the son of Joseph?" they asked. [23] Jesus said to them, "Surely you will quote this proverb to Me: 'Physician, heal yourself! Do here in Your hometown what we have heard that You did in Capernaum.'"

[24] Then He added, "Truly I tell you, no prophet is accepted in his hometown." [25] But I tell you truthfully that there were many widows in Israel in the time of Elijah, when the sky was shut for three and a half years and great famine swept over all the land. [26] Yet Elijah was not sent to any of them, but to the widow of Zarephath in Sidon. [27] "And there were many lepers in Israel in the time of Elisha the prophet. Yet not one of them was cleansed—only Naaman the Syrian." [28] On hearing this, all the people in the synagogue were enraged.

[29] They got up, drove Him out of the town, and led Him to the brow of the hill on which the town was built, in order to throw Him over the cliff. [30] But Jesus passed through the crowd and went on His way. [31] Then He went down to Capernaum, a town in Galilee, and on the Sabbath He began to teach the people. [32] They were astonished at His teaching, because His message had authority. [33] In the synagogue there was a man possessed by the spirit of an unclean demon. He cried out in a loud voice, [34] "Ha! What do You want with us, Jesus of Nazareth? Have You come to destroy us? I know who You are—the Holy One of God!" [35] But Jesus rebuked the demon. "Be silent!" He said. "Come out of him!" At this, the demon threw the man down before them all and came out without harming him. [36] All the people were overcome with amazement and asked one another, "What is this message? With authority and power He commands the unclean spirits, and they come out!" [37] And the news about Jesus spread throughout the surrounding region. [38] After Jesus had left the synagogue, He went to the home of Simon, whose mother-in-law was suffering from a high fever. So they appealed to Jesus on her behalf, [39] and He stood over her and rebuked the fever, and it left her. And she got up at once and began to serve them. [40] At sunset, all who were ill with various diseases were brought to Jesus, and laying His hands on each one, He healed them. [41] Demons also came out of many people, shouting, "You are the Son of God!" But He rebuked the demons and would not allow them to speak, because they knew He was the Christ. [42] At daybreak, Jesus went out to a solitary place, and the crowds were looking for Him. They came to Him and tried to keep Him from leaving. [43] But Jesus told them, "I must preach the good news of the kingdom of God to the other towns as well, because that is why I was sent." [44] And He continued to preach in the synagogues of Judea.

5 On one occasion, while Jesus was standing by the Lake of Gennesaret with
the crowd pressing in on Him to hear the word of God, [2] He saw two boats at
the edge of the lake. The fishermen had left them and were washing their nets.
[3] Jesus got into the boat belonging to Simon and asked him to put out a little
from shore. And sitting down, He taught the people from the boat. [4] When Jesus
had finished speaking, He said to Simon, "Put out into deep water and let down
your nets for a catch." [5] "Master," Simon replied, "we have worked hard all night
without catching anything. But because You say so, I will let down the nets."
[6] When they had done so, they caught such a large number of fish that their nets
began to tear. [7] So they signaled to their partners in the other boat to come and
help them, and they came and filled both boats so full that they began to sink.
[8] When Simon Peter saw this, he fell at Jesus' knees. "Go away from me, Lord,"
he said, "for I am a sinful man." [9] For he and his companions were astonished
at the catch of fish they had taken, [10] and so were his partners James and John,
the sons of Zebedee. "Do not be afraid," Jesus said to Simon. "From now on
you will catch men." [11] And when they had brought their boats ashore, they left
everything and followed Him. [12] While Jesus was in one of the towns, a man came
along who was covered with leprosy. When he saw Jesus, he fell facedown and
begged Him, "Lord, if You are willing, You can make me clean."
[13] Jesus reached out His hand and touched the man. "I am willing," He said.
"Be clean!" And immediately the leprosy left him. [14] "Do not tell anyone," Jesus
instructed him. "But go, show yourself to the priest and present the offering
Moses prescribed for your cleansing, as a testimony to them." [15] But the news
about Jesus spread all the more, and great crowds came to hear Him and to be
healed of their sicknesses. [16] Yet He frequently withdrew to the wilderness to pray.
[17] One day Jesus was teaching, and the Pharisees and teachers of the law were
sitting there. People had come from Jerusalem and from every village of Galilee
and Judea, and the power of the Lord was present for Him to heal the sick. [18] Just
then some men came carrying a paralyzed man on a mat. They tried to bring him
inside to set him before Jesus, [19] but they could not find a way through the crowd.
So they went up on the roof and lowered him on his mat through the tiles into
the middle of the crowd, right in front of Jesus. [20] When Jesus saw their faith, He
said, "Friend, your sins are forgiven."
[21] But the scribes and Pharisees began thinking to themselves, "Who is this
man who speaks blasphemy? Who can forgive sins but God alone?" [22] Knowing
what they were thinking, Jesus replied, "Why are you thinking these things in
your hearts?" [23] Which is easier: to say, 'Your sins are forgiven,' or to say, 'Get up
and walk?' [24] "But so that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on
the earth to forgive sins..." He said to the paralytic, "I tell you, get up, pick up
your mat, and go home." [25] And immediately the man stood up before them,
took what he had been lying on, and went home glorifying God.

[26] Everyone was taken with amazement and glorified God. They were filled
with awe and said, "We have seen remarkable things today." [27] After this, Jesus
went out and saw a tax collector named Levi sitting at the tax booth. "Follow
Me," He told him, [28] and Levi got up, left everything, and followed Him.
[29] Then Levi hosted a great banquet for Jesus at his house. A large crowd of tax
collectors was there, along with others who were eating with them. [30] But the
Pharisees and their scribes complained to Jesus' disciples, "Why do you eat and
drink with tax collectors and sinners?" [31] Jesus answered, "It is not the healthy
who need a doctor, but the sick." [32] "I have not come to call the righteous, but
sinners, to repentance." [33] Then they said to Him, "John's disciples and those of
the Pharisees frequently fast and pray, but Yours keep on eating and drinking."
[34] Jesus replied, "Can you make the guests of the bridegroom fast while He is
with them?" [35] "But the time will come when the bridegroom will be taken from
them; then they will fast." [36] He also told them a parable: "No one tears a piece
of cloth from a new garment and sews it on an old one. If he does, he will tear
the new garment as well, and the patch from the new will not match the old."
[37] And no one pours new wine into old wineskins. If he does, the new wine will
burst the skins, the wine will spill, and the wineskins will be ruined. [38] Instead,
new wine is poured into new wineskins. [39] "And no one after drinking old wine
wants new, for he says, 'The old is better.'"

6 One Sabbath Jesus was passing through the grainfields, and His disciples
began to pick the heads of grain, rub them in their hands, and eat them.
[2] But some of the Pharisees asked, "Why are you doing what is unlawful on
the Sabbath?" [3] Jesus replied, "Have you not read what David did when he
and his companions were hungry?" [4] "He entered the house of God, took
the consecrated bread and gave it to his companions, and ate what is lawful
only for the priests to eat." [5] Then Jesus declared, "The Son of Man is Lord
of the Sabbath." [6] On another Sabbath Jesus entered the synagogue and was
teaching, and a man was there whose right hand was withered. [7] Looking for a
reason to accuse Jesus, the scribes and Pharisees were watching Him closely to
see if He would heal on the Sabbath. [8] But Jesus knew their thoughts and said
to the man with the withered hand, "Get up and stand among us." So he got
up and stood there. [9] Then Jesus said to them, "I ask you, which is lawful on
the Sabbath: to do good or to do evil, to save life or to destroy it?" [10] And after
looking around at all of them, He said to the man, "Stretch out your hand." He
did so, and it was restored. [11] But the scribes and Pharisees were filled with rage
and began to discuss with one another what they might do to Jesus. [12] In those
days Jesus went out to the mountain to pray, and He spent the night in prayer
to God. [13] When daylight came, He called His disciples to Him and chose twelve
of them, whom He also designated as apostles: [14] Simon, whom He named Peter,
and his brother Andrew; James and John; Philip and Bartholomew; [15] Matthew
and Thomas; James son of Alphaeus and Simon called the Zealot; [16] Judas son
of James, and Judas Iscariot, who became a traitor. [17] Then Jesus came down
with them and stood on a level place. A large crowd of His disciples was there,
along with a great number of people from all over Judea, Jerusalem, and the sea
coast of Tyre and Sidon. [18] They had come to hear Him and to be healed of their
diseases, and those troubled by unclean spirits were healed. [19] The entire crowd
was trying to touch Him, because power was coming from Him and healing
them all. [20] Looking up at His disciples, Jesus said: "Blessed are you who are poor,
for yours is the kingdom of God."
[21] Blessed are you who hunger now, for you will be filled. Blessed are you who
weep now, for you will laugh. [22] Blessed are you when people hate you, and when
they exclude you and insult you and reject your name as evil because of the Son
of Man. [23] Rejoice in that day and leap for joy, because great is your reward in
heaven. For their fathers treated the prophets in the same way. [24] But woe to you
who are rich, for you have already received your comfort. [25] Woe to you who are
well fed now, for you will hunger. Woe to you who laugh now, for you will mourn
and weep. [26] Woe to you when all men speak well of you, for their fathers treated
the false prophets in the same way. [27] But to those of you who will listen, I say:
Love your enemies, do good to those who hate you, [28] bless those who curse you,
pray for those who mistreat you. [29] If someone strikes you on one cheek, turn to
him the other also. And if someone takes your cloak, do not withhold your tunic
as well. [30] Give to everyone who asks you, and if anyone takes what is yours, do
not demand it back. [31] Do to others as you would have them do to you.

[32] If you love those who love you, what credit is that to you? Even sinners love
those who love them. [33] If you do good to those who do good to you, what credit
is that to you? Even sinners do the same. [34] And if you lend to those from whom
you expect repayment, what credit is that to you? Even sinners lend to sinners,
expecting to be repaid in full. [35] But love your enemies, do good to them, and
lend to them, expecting nothing in return. Then your reward will be great, and
you will be sons of the Most High; for He is kind to the ungrateful and wicked.
[36] Be merciful, just as your Father is merciful. [37] Do not judge, and you will not
be judged. Do not condemn, and you will not be condemned. Forgive, and you
will be forgiven. [38] "Give, and it will be given to you. A good measure, pressed
down, shaken together, and running over will be poured into your lap. For with
the measure you use, it will be measured back to you." [39] Jesus also told them a
parable: "Can a blind man lead a blind man? Will they not both fall into a pit?"
[40] A disciple is not above his teacher, but everyone who is fully trained will be
like his teacher. [41] Why do you look at the speck in your brother's eye, but fail to
notice the beam in your own eye? [42] How can you say, 'Brother, let me take the
speck out of your eye,' while you yourself fail to see the beam in your own eye?
You hypocrite! First take the beam out of your own eye, and then you will see
clearly to remove the speck from your brother's eye. [43] No good tree bears bad
fruit, nor does a bad tree bear good fruit. [44] For each tree is known by its own
fruit. Indeed, figs are not gathered from thornbushes, nor grapes from brambles.
[45] The good man brings good things out of the good treasure of his heart, and
the evil man brings evil things out of the evil treasure of his heart. For out of the
overflow of the heart, the mouth speaks. [46] Why do you call Me 'Lord, Lord,'
but not do what I say? [47] I will show you what he is like who comes to Me and
hears My words and acts on them: [48] He is like a man building a house, who dug
down deep and laid his foundation on the rock. When the flood came, the torrent
crashed against that house but could not shake it, because it was well built. [49] "But
the one who hears My words and does not act on them is like a man who built his
house on ground without a foundation. The torrent crashed against that house,
and immediately it fell—and great was its destruction!"

7 When Jesus had concluded His discourse in the hearing of the people, He
went to Capernaum. [2] There a highly valued servant of a centurion was sick and
about to die. [3] When the centurion heard about Jesus, he sent some Jewish elders
to ask Him to come and heal his servant. [4] They came to Jesus and pleaded with
Him earnestly, "This man is worthy to have You grant this," [5] "for he loves our
nation and has built our synagogue." [6] So Jesus went with them. But when He
was not far from the house, the centurion sent friends with the message: "Lord,
do not trouble Yourself, for I am not worthy to have You come under my roof."
[7] That is why I did not consider myself worthy to come to You. But just say the
word, and my servant will be healed. [8] "For I myself am a man under authority,
with soldiers under me. I tell one to go, and he goes; and another to come, and
he comes. I tell my servant to do something, and he does it." [9] When Jesus heard
this, He marveled at the centurion. Turning to the crowd following Him, He
said, "I tell you, not even in Israel have I found such great faith." [10] And when
the messengers returned to the house, they found the servant in good health.
[11] Soon afterward, Jesus went to a town called Nain. His disciples went with Him,
accompanied by a large crowd. [12] As He approached the town gate, He saw a dead
man being carried out, the only son of his mother, and she was a widow. And
a large crowd from the town was with her. [13] When the Lord saw her, He had
compassion on her and said, "Do not weep." [14] Then He went up and touched
the coffin, and those carrying it stood still. "Young man," He said, "I tell you,
get up!" [15] And the dead man sat up and began to speak! Then Jesus gave him
back to his mother.

16 A sense of awe swept over all of them, and they glorified God. "A great
prophet has appeared among us!" they said. "God has visited His people!" 17 And
the news about Jesus spread throughout Judea and all the surrounding region.
18 Then John's disciples informed him about all these things. 19 So John called
two of his disciples and sent them to ask the Lord, "Are You the One who was
to come, or should we look for someone else?" 20 When the men came to Jesus,
they said, "John the Baptist sent us to ask, 'Are You the One who was to come,
or should we look for someone else?'" 21 At that very hour Jesus healed many
people of their diseases, afflictions, and evil spirits, and He gave sight to many
who were blind.

22 So He replied, "Go back and report to John what you have seen and heard:
The blind receive sight, the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear, the
dead are raised, and the good news is preached to the poor." 23 "Blessed is the one
who does not fall away on account of Me." 24 After John's messengers had left,
Jesus began to speak to the crowds about John: "What did you go out into the
wilderness to see? A reed swaying in the wind?" 25 Otherwise, what did you go out
to see? A man dressed in fine clothes? Look, those who wear elegant clothing and
live in luxury are found in palaces. 26 What then did you go out to see? A prophet?
Yes, I tell you, and more than a prophet. 27 This is the one about whom it is
written: 'Behold, I will send My messenger ahead of You, who will prepare Your
way before You.' 28 "I tell you, among those born of women there is no one greater
than John, yet even the least in the kingdom of God is greater than he." 29 All
the people who heard this, even the tax collectors, acknowledged God's justice.
For they had received the baptism of John. 30 But the Pharisees and experts in the
law rejected God's purpose for themselves, because they had not been baptized
by John. 31 "To what, then, can I compare the men of this generation? What are
they like?" 32 They are like children sitting in the marketplace and calling out to
one another: 'We played the flute for you, and you did not dance; we sang a dirge,
and you did not weep.'

33 For John the Baptist came neither eating bread nor drinking wine, and you
say, 'He has a demon!' 34 The Son of Man came eating and drinking, and you
say, 'Look at this glutton and drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!'
35 "But wisdom is vindicated by all her children." 36 Then one of the Pharisees
invited Jesus to eat with him, and He entered the Pharisee's house and reclined at
the table. 37 When a sinful woman from that town learned that Jesus was dining
there, she brought an alabaster jar of perfume. 38 As she stood behind Him at
His feet weeping, she began to wet His feet with her tears and wipe them with
her hair. Then she kissed His feet and anointed them with the perfume. 39 When
the Pharisee who had invited Jesus saw this, he said to himself, "If this man were
a prophet, He would know who this is and what kind of woman is touching
Him—for she is a sinner!" 40 But Jesus answered him, "Simon, I have something
to tell you." "Tell me, Teacher," he said. 41 "Two men were debtors to a certain
moneylender. One owed him five hundred denarii, and the other fifty." 42 "When
they were unable to repay him, he forgave both of them. Which one, then, will
love him more?" 43 "I suppose the one who was forgiven more," Simon replied.
"You have judged correctly," Jesus said. 44 And turning toward the woman, He
said to Simon, "Do you see this woman? When I entered your house, you did
not give Me water for My feet, but she wet My feet with her tears and wiped
them with her hair." 45 You did not greet Me with a kiss, but she has not stopped
kissing My feet since I arrived. 46 You did not anoint My head with oil, but she
has anointed My feet with perfume. 47 "Therefore I tell you, because her many
sins have been forgiven, she has loved much. But he who has been forgiven little
loves little." 48 Then Jesus said to her, "Your sins are forgiven." 49 But those at the
table began to say to themselves, "Who is this who even forgives sins?" 50 And
Jesus told the woman, "Your faith has saved you; go in peace."

8 Soon afterward, Jesus traveled from one town and village to another,
preaching and proclaiming the good news of the kingdom of God. The Twelve
were with Him, 2 as well as some women who had been healed of evil spirits and
infirmities: Mary called Magdalene, from whom seven demons had gone out,
3 Joanna the wife of Herod's household manager Chuza, Susanna, and many
others. These women were ministering to them out of their own means. 4 While
a large crowd was gathering and people were coming to Jesus from town after
town, He told them this parable: 5 "A farmer went out to sow his seed. And as
he was sowing, some seed fell along the path, where it was trampled, and the
birds of the air devoured it." 6 Some fell on rocky ground, and when it came up,
the seedlings withered because they had no moisture. 7 Other seed fell among
thorns, which grew up with it and choked the seedlings. 8 "Still other seed fell on
good soil, where it sprang up and produced a crop—a hundredfold." As Jesus
said this, He called out, "He who has ears to hear, let him hear." 9 Then His
disciples asked Him what this parable meant. 10 He replied, "The knowledge of
the mysteries of the kingdom of God has been given to you, but to others I speak
in parables, so that, 'though seeing, they may not see; though hearing, they may
not understand.'" 11 Now this is the meaning of the parable: The seed is the word
of God. 12 The seeds along the path are those who hear, but the devil comes and
takes away the word from their hearts, so that they may not believe and be saved.
13 The seeds on rocky ground are those who hear the word and receive it with
joy, but they have no root. They believe for a season, but in the time of testing,
they fall away. 14 The seeds that fell among the thorns are those who hear, but
as they go on their way, they are choked by the worries, riches, and pleasures of
this life, and their fruit does not mature. 15 But the seeds on good soil are those
with a noble and good heart, who hear the word, cling to it, and by persevering
produce a crop. 16 No one lights a lamp and covers it with a jar or puts it under a
bed. Instead, he sets it on a stand, so those who enter can see the light. 17 For there
is nothing hidden that will not be disclosed, and nothing concealed that will not
be made known and brought to light.

18 "Pay attention, therefore, to how you listen. Whoever has will be given
more, but whoever does not have, even what he thinks he has will be taken
away from him." 19 Then Jesus' mother and brothers came to see Him, but they
were unable to reach Him because of the crowd. 20 He was told, "Your mother
and brothers are standing outside, wanting to see You." 21 But He replied, "My
mother and brothers are those who hear the word of God and carry it out."
22 One day Jesus said to His disciples, "Let us cross to the other side of the lake."
So He got into a boat with them and set out.

23 As they sailed, He fell asleep, and a windstorm came down on the lake, so
that the boat was being swamped, and they were in great danger. 24 The disciples
went and woke Him, saying, "Master, Master, we are perishing!" Then Jesus
got up and rebuked the wind and the raging waters, and they subsided, and
all was calm. 25 "Where is your faith?" He asked. Frightened and amazed, they
asked one another, "Who is this? He commands even the winds and the water,
and they obey Him!" 26 Then they sailed to the region of the Gerasenes, across
the lake from Galilee. 27 When Jesus stepped ashore, He was met by a demon-
possessed man from the town. For a long time this man had not worn clothing or
lived in a house, but he stayed in the tombs. 28 When the man saw Jesus, he cried
out and fell down before Him, shouting in a loud voice, "What do You want
with me, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? I beg You not to torture me!" 29 For
Jesus had commanded the unclean spirit to come out of the man. Many times
it had seized him, and though he was bound with chains and shackles, he had
broken the chains and been driven by the demon into solitary places. 30 "What is
your name?" Jesus asked. "Legion," he replied, because many demons had gone
into him. 31 And the demons kept begging Jesus not to order them to go into
the Abyss. 32 There on the hillside a large herd of pigs was feeding. So the demons
begged Jesus to let them enter the pigs, and He gave them permission. 33 Then the
demons came out of the man and went into the pigs, and the herd rushed down
the steep bank into the lake and was drowned. 34 When those tending the pigs saw
what had happened, they ran off and reported this in the town and countryside.
35 So the people went out to see what had happened. They came to Jesus and
found the man whom the demons had left, sitting at Jesus' feet, clothed and in his
right mind; and they were afraid. 36 Meanwhile, those who had seen it reported
how the demon-possessed man had been healed.

37 Then all the people of the region of the Gerasenes asked Jesus to depart from
them, because great fear had taken hold of them. So He got into the boat and
started back. 38 The man whom the demons had left begged to go with Jesus.
But He sent him away, saying, 39 "Return home and describe how much God
has done for you." So the man went away and proclaimed all over the town how
much Jesus had done for him. 40 When Jesus returned, the crowd welcomed Him,
for they had all been waiting for Him. 41 Just then a synagogue leader named
Jairus came and fell at Jesus' feet. He begged Him to come to his house, 42 because
his only daughter, who was about twelve, was dying. As Jesus went with him,
the crowds pressed around Him, 43 including a woman who had suffered from
bleeding for twelve years. She had spent all her money on physicians, but no
one was able to heal her. 44 She came up behind Jesus and touched the fringe of
His cloak, and immediately her bleeding stopped. 45 "Who touched Me?" Jesus
asked. But they all denied it. "Master," said Peter, "the people are crowding and
pressing against You." 46 But Jesus declared, "Someone touched Me, for I know
that power has gone out from Me." 47 Then the woman, seeing that she could
not escape notice, came trembling and fell down before Him. In the presence
of all the people, she explained why she had touched Him and how she had
immediately been healed. 48 "Daughter," said Jesus, "your faith has healed you.
Go in peace." 49 While He was still speaking, someone arrived from the house
of the synagogue leader. "Your daughter is dead," he told Jairus. "Do not bother
the Teacher anymore." 50 But Jesus overheard them and said to Jairus, "Do not
be afraid; just believe, and she will be healed." 51 When He entered the house,
He did not allow anyone to go in with Him except Peter, John, James, and the
child's father and mother. 52 Meanwhile, everyone was weeping and mourning
for her. But Jesus said, "Stop weeping; she is not dead but asleep." 53 And they
laughed at Him, knowing that she was dead. 54 But Jesus took her by the hand and
called out, "Child, get up!" 55 Her spirit returned, and at once she got up. And
He directed that she be given something to eat. 56 Her parents were astounded,
but Jesus ordered them not to tell anyone what had happened.

9 Then Jesus called the Twelve together and gave them power and authority
over all demons, and power to cure diseases. 2 And He sent them out to
proclaim the kingdom of God and to heal the sick. 3 "Take nothing for the
journey," He told them, "no staff, no bag, no bread, no money, no second tunic."
4 Whatever house you enter, stay there until you leave that area. 5 "If anyone
does not welcome you, shake the dust off your feet when you leave that town,
as a testimony against them." 6 So they set out and went from village to village,
preaching the gospel and healing people everywhere. 7 When Herod the tetrarch
heard about all that was happening, he was perplexed. For some were saying that
John had risen from the dead, 8 others that Elijah had appeared, and still others
that a prophet of old had arisen. 9 "I beheaded John," Herod said, "but who is

this man I hear such things about?" And he kept trying to see Jesus. [10] Then the apostles returned and reported to Jesus all that they had done. Taking them away privately, He withdrew to a town called Bethsaida. [11] But the crowds found out and followed Him. He welcomed them and spoke to them about the kingdom of God, and He healed those who needed healing. [12] As the day neared its end, the Twelve came to Jesus and said, "Dismiss the crowd so they can go to the surrounding villages and countryside for lodging and provisions. For we are in a desolate place here." [13] But Jesus told them, "You give them something to eat." "We have only five loaves of bread and two fish," they answered, "unless we go and buy food for all these people." [14] (There were about five thousand men.) He told His disciples, "Have them sit down in groups of about fifty each." [15] They did so, and everyone was seated. [16] Taking the five loaves and the two fish and looking up to heaven, Jesus spoke a blessing and broke them. Then He gave them to the disciples to set before the people. [17] They all ate and were satisfied, and the disciples picked up twelve basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over. [18] One day as Jesus was praying in private and the disciples were with Him, He questioned them: "Who do the crowds say I am?" [19] They replied, "Some say John the Baptist; others say Elijah; and still others, that a prophet of old has arisen."

[20] "But what about you?" Jesus asked. "Who do you say I am?" Peter answered, "The Christ of God." [21] Jesus strictly warned them not to tell this to anyone. [22] "The Son of Man must suffer many things," He said. "He must be rejected by the elders, chief priests, and scribes, and He must be killed and on the third day be raised to life." [23] Then Jesus said to all of them, "If anyone wants to come after Me, he must deny himself and take up his cross daily and follow Me." [24] For whoever wants to save his life will lose it, but whoever loses his life for My sake will save it. [25] What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet lose or forfeit his very self? [26] If anyone is ashamed of Me and My words, the Son of Man will be ashamed of him when He comes in His glory and in the glory of the Father and of the holy angels. [27] "But I tell you truthfully, some who are standing here will not taste death before they see the kingdom of God." [28] About eight days after Jesus had said these things, He took with Him Peter, John, and James, and went up on a mountain to pray. [29] And as He was praying, the appearance of His face changed, and His clothes became radiantly white. [30] Suddenly two men, Moses and Elijah, began talking with Jesus. [31] They appeared in glory and spoke about His departure, which He was about to accomplish at Jerusalem. [32] Meanwhile Peter and his companions were overcome by sleep, but when they awoke, they saw Jesus' glory and the two men standing with Him. [33] As Moses and Elijah were leaving, Peter said to Jesus, "Master, it is good for us to be here. Let us put up three shelters—one for You, one for Moses, and one for Elijah." (He did not know what he was saying.) [34] While Peter was speaking, a cloud appeared and enveloped them, and they were afraid as they entered the cloud. [35] And a voice came from the cloud, saying, "This is My Son, whom I have chosen. Listen to Him!" [36] After the voice had spoken, only Jesus was present with them. The disciples kept this to themselves, and in those days they did not tell anyone what they had seen. [37] The next day, when they came down from the mountain, Jesus was met by a large crowd. [38] Suddenly a man in the crowd cried out, "Teacher, I beg You to look at my son, for he is my only child." [39] A spirit keeps seizing him, and he screams abruptly. It throws him into convulsions so that he foams at the mouth. It keeps mauling him and rarely departs from him. [40] "I begged Your disciples to drive it out, but they were unable."

[41] "O unbelieving and perverse generation!" Jesus replied. "How long must I remain with you and put up with you? Bring your son here." [42] Even while the boy was approaching, the demon slammed him to the ground in a convulsion. But Jesus rebuked the unclean spirit, healed the boy, and gave him back to his father. [43] And they were all astonished at the greatness of God. While everyone was marveling at all that Jesus was doing, He said to His disciples, [44] "Let these words sink into your ears: The Son of Man is about to be delivered into the hands of men." [45] But they did not understand this statement. It was veiled from them so that they could not comprehend it, and they were afraid to ask Him about it.

[46] Then an argument started among the disciples as to which of them would be the greatest. [47] But Jesus, knowing the thoughts of their hearts, had a little child stand beside Him. [48] And He said to them, "Whoever welcomes this little child in My name welcomes Me, and whoever welcomes Me welcomes the One who sent Me. For whoever is the least among all of you, he is the greatest." [49] "Master," said John, "we saw someone driving out demons in Your name, and we tried to stop him, because he does not accompany us." [50] "Do not stop him," Jesus replied, "for whoever is not against you is for you." [51] As the day of His ascension approached, Jesus resolutely set out for Jerusalem. [52] He sent messengers on ahead, who went into a village of the Samaritans to make arrangements for Him. [53] But the people there refused to welcome Him, because He was heading for Jerusalem. [54] When the disciples James and John saw this, they asked, "Lord, do You want us to call down fire from heaven to consume them?" [55] But Jesus turned and rebuked them. [56] And He and His disciples went on to another village. [57] As they were walking along the road, someone said to Jesus, "I will follow You wherever You go." [58] Jesus replied, "Foxes have dens and birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has no place to lay His head." [59] Then He said to another man, "Follow Me." The man replied, "Lord, first let me go and bury my father." [60] But Jesus told him, "Let the dead bury their own dead. You, however, go and proclaim the kingdom of God." [61] Still another said, "I will follow You, Lord; but first let me bid farewell to my family." [62] Then Jesus declared, "No one who puts his hand to the plow and then looks back is fit for the kingdom of God."

10 After this, the Lord appointed seventy-two others and sent them two by two ahead of Him to every town and place He was about to visit. [2] And He told them, "The harvest is plentiful, but the workers are few. Ask the Lord of the harvest, therefore, to send out workers into His harvest." [3] Go! I am sending you out like lambs among wolves. [4] Carry no purse or bag or sandals. Do not greet anyone along the road. [5] Whatever house you enter, begin by saying, 'Peace to this house.' [6] If a man of peace is there, your peace will rest on him; if not, it will return to you. [7] Stay at the same house, eating and drinking whatever you are offered. For the worker is worthy of his wages. Do not move around from house to house. [8] If you enter a town and they welcome you, eat whatever is set before you. [9] Heal the sick who are there and tell them, 'The kingdom of God is near you.' [10] But if you enter a town and they do not welcome you, go into the streets and declare, [11] 'Even the dust of your town that clings to our feet, we wipe off as a testimony against you. Yet be sure of this: The kingdom of God is near.' [12] I tell you, it will be more bearable on that day for Sodom than for that town. [13] Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you, Bethsaida! For if the miracles that were performed in you had been performed in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago, sitting in sackcloth and ashes.

[14] But it will be more bearable for Tyre and Sidon at the judgment than for you. [15] And you, Capernaum, will you be lifted up to heaven? No, you will be brought down to Hades! [16] "Whoever listens to you listens to Me; whoever rejects you rejects Me; and whoever rejects Me rejects the One who sent Me." [17] The seventy-two returned with joy and said, "Lord, even the demons submit to us in Your name." [18] So He told them, "I saw Satan fall like lightning from heaven."

[19] Behold, I have given you authority to tread on snakes and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy. Nothing will harm you. [20] "Nevertheless, do not rejoice that the spirits submit to you, but rejoice that your names are written in heaven." [21] At that time Jesus rejoiced in the Holy Spirit and declared, "I praise You, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because You have hidden these things from the wise and learned, and revealed them to little children. Yes, Father, for this was well-pleasing in Your sight." [22] "All things have been entrusted to Me by My Father. No one knows who the Son is except the Father, and no one knows who the Father is except the Son and those to whom the Son chooses to reveal Him." [23] Then Jesus turned to the disciples and said privately, "Blessed are the eyes that see what you see." [24] "For I tell you that many prophets and kings desired to see what you see but did not see it, and to hear what you hear but did not hear it." [25] One day an expert in the law stood up to test Him. "Teacher," he asked, "what must I do to inherit eternal life?" [26] "What is written in the Law?" Jesus replied. "How do you read it?" [27] He answered, "'Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your strength and with all your mind' and 'Love your neighbor as yourself.'"

[28] "You have answered correctly," Jesus said. "Do this and you will live." [29] But wanting to justify himself, he asked Jesus, "And who is my neighbor?" [30] Jesus took up this question and said, "A man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho when he fell into the hands of robbers. They stripped him, beat him, and went away, leaving him half dead." [31] Now by chance a priest was going down the same road, but when he saw him, he passed by on the other side. [32] So too, when a Levite came to that spot and saw him, he passed by on the other side. [33] But when a Samaritan on a journey came upon him, he looked at him and had compassion. [34] He went to him and bandaged his wounds, pouring on oil and wine. Then he put him on his own animal, brought him to an inn, and took care of him. [35] The next day he took out two denarii and gave them to the innkeeper. 'Take care of him,' he said, 'and on my return I will repay you for any additional expense.' [36] "Which of these three do you think was a neighbor to the man who fell into the hands of robbers?" [37] "The one who showed him mercy," replied the expert in the law. Then Jesus told him, "Go and do likewise." [38] As they traveled along, Jesus entered a village where a woman named Martha welcomed Him into her home. [39] She had a sister named Mary, who sat at the Lord's feet listening to His message. [40] But Martha was distracted by all the preparations to be made. She came to Jesus and said, "Lord, do You not care that my sister has left me to serve alone? Tell her to help me!" [41] "Martha, Martha," the Lord replied, "you are worried and upset about many things." [42] "But only one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the good portion, and it will not be taken away from her."

11 One day in a place where Jesus had just finished praying, one of His disciples requested, "Lord, teach us to pray, just as John taught his disciples." [2] So Jesus told them, "When you pray, say: 'Father, hallowed be Your name. Your kingdom come.'" [3] Give us each day our daily bread. [4] "And forgive us our sins, for we also forgive everyone who sins against us. And lead us not into temptation.'" [5] Then Jesus said to them, "Suppose one of you goes to his friend at midnight and says, 'Friend, lend me three loaves of bread,'" [6] because a friend of mine has come to me on a journey, and I have nothing to set before him.' [7] And suppose the one inside answers, 'Do not bother me. My door is already shut, and my children and I are in bed. I cannot get up to give you anything.' [8] I tell you, even though he will not get up to provide for him because of his friendship, yet because of the man's persistence, he will get up and give him as much as he needs. [9] So I tell you: Ask, and it will be given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and the door will be opened to you. [10] For everyone who asks receives; he who seeks finds; and to him who knocks, the door will be opened. [11] What father among

you, if his son asks for a fish, will give him a snake instead? [12] Or if he asks for an egg, will give him a scorpion? [13] "So if you who are evil know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give the Holy Spirit to those who ask Him!" [14] One day Jesus was driving out a demon that was mute. And when the demon was gone, the man who had been mute spoke. The crowds were amazed, [15] but some of them said, "It is by Beelzebul, the prince of the demons, that He drives out demons." [16] And others tested Him by demanding a sign from heaven. [17] Knowing their thoughts, Jesus said to them, "Every kingdom divided against itself will be laid waste, and a house divided against a house will fall."

[18] If Satan is divided against himself, how can his kingdom stand? After all, you say that I drive out demons by Beelzebul. [19] And if I drive out demons by Beelzebul, by whom do your sons drive them out? So then, they will be your judges. [20] But if I drive out demons by the finger of God, then the kingdom of God has come upon you. [21] When a strong man, fully armed, guards his house, his possessions are secure. [22] But when someone stronger attacks and overpowers him, he takes away the armor in which the man trusted, and then he divides up his plunder. [23] He who is not with Me is against Me, and he who does not gather with Me scatters. [24] When an unclean spirit comes out of a man, it passes through arid places seeking rest and does not find it. Then it says, 'I will return to the house I left.' [25] On its return, it finds the house swept clean and put in order.

[26] "Then it goes and brings seven other spirits more wicked than itself, and they go in and dwell there. And the final plight of that man is worse than the first." [27] As Jesus was saying these things, a woman in the crowd raised her voice and said, "Blessed is the womb that bore You, and blessed are the breasts that nursed You!" [28] But He replied, "Blessed rather are those who hear the word of God and obey it." [29] As the crowds were increasing, Jesus said, "This is a wicked generation. It demands a sign, but none will be given it except the sign of Jonah." [30] For as Jonah was a sign to the Ninevites, so the Son of Man will be a sign to this generation. [31] The Queen of the South will rise at the judgment with the men of this generation and condemn them; for she came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon, and now One greater than Solomon is here. [32] The men of Nineveh will stand at the judgment with this generation and condemn it; for they repented at the preaching of Jonah, and now One greater than Jonah is here. [33] No one lights a lamp and puts it in a cellar or under a basket. Instead, he sets it on a stand, so those who enter can see the light. [34] Your eye is the lamp of your body. When your eyes are good, your whole body also is full of light. But when they are bad, your body is full of darkness. [35] Be careful, then, that the light within you is not darkness.

[36] "So if your whole body is full of light, with no part of it in darkness, you will be radiant, as though a lamp were shining on you." [37] As Jesus was speaking, a Pharisee invited Him to dine with him; so He went in and reclined at the table. [38] But the Pharisee was surprised to see that Jesus did not first wash before the meal. [39] "Now then," said the Lord, "you Pharisees clean the outside of the cup and dish, but inside you are full of greed and wickedness." [40] You fools! Did not the One who made the outside make the inside as well? [41] But give as alms the things that are within you, and you will see that everything is clean for you. [42] Woe to you Pharisees! You pay tithes of mint, rue, and every herb, but you disregard justice and the love of God. You should have practiced the latter without neglecting the former. [43] Woe to you Pharisees! You love the chief seats in the synagogues and the greetings in the marketplaces. [44] "Woe to you! For you are like unmarked graves, which men walk over without even noticing." [45] One of the experts in the law told Him, "Teacher, when You say these things, You insult us as well." [46] "Woe to you as well, experts in the law!" He replied. "You weigh men down with heavy burdens, but you yourselves will not lift a finger to lighten their load." [47] Woe to you! You build tombs for the prophets, but it was your fathers who killed them. [48] So you are witnesses consenting to the deeds of your fathers: They killed the prophets, and you build their tombs. [49] Because of this, the wisdom of God said, 'I will send them prophets and apostles; some of them they will kill and others they will persecute.' [50] As a result, this generation will be charged with the blood of all the prophets that has been shed since the foundation of the world, [51] from the blood of Abel to the blood of Zechariah, who was killed between the altar and the sanctuary. Yes, I tell you, all of it will be charged to this generation. [52] "Woe to you experts in the law! For you have taken away the key to knowledge. You yourselves have not entered, and you have hindered those who were entering." [53] As Jesus went on from there, the scribes and Pharisees began to oppose Him bitterly and to ply Him with questions about many things, [54] waiting to catch Him in something He might say.

12 In the meantime, a crowd of many thousands had gathered, so that they were trampling one another. Jesus began to speak first to His disciples: "Beware of the leaven of the Pharisees, which is hypocrisy." [2] There is nothing concealed that will not be disclosed, and nothing hidden that will not be made known. [3] What you have spoken in the dark will be heard in the daylight, and what you have whispered in the inner rooms will be proclaimed from the housetops. [4] I tell you, My friends, do not be afraid of those who kill the body and after that can do no more. [5] But I will show you whom you should fear: Fear the One who, after you have been killed, has authority to throw you into hell. Yes, I tell you, fear Him! [6] Are not five sparrows sold for two pennies? Yet not one of them is forgotten by God. [7] And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows. [8] I tell you, everyone who confesses Me before men, the Son of Man will also confess him before the angels of God. [9] But whoever denies Me before men will be denied before the angels of God.